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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (Honours)/ MGU-BBA (Honours)/ MGU-BCA (Honours)
REGULAR EXAMINATION October 2026
Fifth SEMESTER
Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG5DSCFDG301 - GARMENT EXPORT MERCHANDISING
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I), and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Short Answers
Answer any **10** questions
Each question carries **2** marks

1.Define garment costing. [K] / [CO1]

Garment costing is the process of calculating the total cost involved in producing a garment and determining its selling price.

2.How to prepare an export document?

Export documents are prepared by the exporter based on the buyer's order and the requirements of customs and shipping authorities. Important documents include the commercial invoice, packing list, shipping bill, certificate of origin, and bill of lading. [U] / [CO1]

3.Classify samples according to their purpose.

Proto sample, Mock up Sample, Fit sample, Size set sample, Pre production sample, TOP sample, Shipment sample. [U] / [CO3]

4.Explain the purpose of dimensional-stability testing.

Checks shrinkage or growth after washing and Measures the strength of the fabric. [K] / [CO3]

5.What is profit margin?

Profit is the amount earned by a garment manufacturer after covering the costs of producing and selling the garment. [U] / [CO3]

6.Explain the role of colour matching in a lab-dip.

A Lab-Dip (Laboratory Dip) is a small fabric sample dyed in a laboratory to match a specific colour requested by the buyer. It is prepared before bulk dyeing so that the buyer can approve the colour. [U] / [CO3]

7.Which factors influence the total cost of a garment?

Fabric Cost, Trims Cost, CMT charges, Value added services, Fabric testing charges, Transportation cost etc… [K] / [CO3]

8. Discuss the importance of costing in the apparel industry.

[K] / [CO3]

- Gives a complete picture of production cost.
- To identify Profit.

- Includes both direct and indirect manufacturing expenses.
- Helps recover factory overheads through product pricing. Etc….

9. Mention any two disadvantages of manual marker making.

More time consuming, Only suitable for Small scale production, Need skilled labour, More wastage etc… [K] / [CO3]

10. List any two common fabric defects.

- Stains
- Holes
- Spots
- Shade variation
- Printing defects
- Weaving defects
- Knitting defects etc…

[K] / [CO2]

11. State the main function of a sewing needle. [K] / [CO4]

Sewing Needle used to form stitches and join garment components.

[K] / [CO5]

12. What is a Shipping Bill?

[2x10 = 20]

An important customs document containing details of the exported goods and shipment. It is submitted to the relevant customs authority for export clearance.

Part B

Long Answers

Answer any 5 questions

Each question carries 4 marks

13. List any four activities carried out in the mill sector.

- Mill Sector

The mill sector consists of large-scale textile manufacturing units equipped with advanced machinery and technology.
The mill sector contributes significantly to national income, exports, and industrial growth by producing textiles on a large scale. Produces approximately 3–5% of total cloth production. India has more than 3,500 textile mills, including spinning and composite mills. India is the 2nd largest producer of yarn globally. [K] / [CO1]
Major Operations

- Spinning
- Weaving/Knitting
- Processing
- Finishing

14. List any four sources of information used for forecasting.

Fashion forecasting is the process of predicting future trends in colours, fabrics, silhouettes, prints, textures, details and styles.
Information is collected from:

- Fashion weeks [K] / [CO1]
- Trend agencies
- Trade fairs
- Street fashion
- Social media
- Retail markets

15. Differentiate between trims and accessories with suitable examples.

- Trims [U] / [CO2]

Trims are materials used in garment construction in addition to the main fabric. They contribute to the functional and aesthetic characteristics of the garment.

Examples include:

- Sewing thread
- Buttons
- Zippers
- Elastic
- Interlining
- Hook and loop fasteners etc….

➢ Accessories

Accessories are additional materials required for garment finishing, presentation and packaging.
Examples include:

- Hang tags
- Price tags
- Polybags
- Cartons
- Stickers
- Packaging materials etc….

16. Explain in detail. [K] / [CO3]

1. **Order Quantity**
2. **Incoterms.**

➢ Order Quantity

The Order quantity is mean by the total number of garments ordered by the buyer.

It indicates the production volume required for a particular style, colour or size range. Large orders allow fixed expenses such as sampling, production setup and overheads to be distributed over more garments.

Larger quantities generally reduce the cost per garment through economies of scale, while small orders may have a higher unit cost.

➢ Incoterms

International trade terms that define the responsibilities, costs and risks of the buyer and seller during transportation of goods.

Incoterms determine who pays for transportation, insurance, export/import clearance, customs duties and delivery. They are important when calculating the final export price or landed cost.

FOB,CIF,EWX,DDP these are the common Incoterms.

17. Define Vendor and explain the major responsibilities of a garment vendor.

A vendor is a supplier of goods or services. [U] / [CO3]
They supplies raw materials, accessories, or services required for garment manufacturing.
Examples include fabric suppliers, zipper manufacturers, button suppliers, and packaging providers.

18. Differentiate between the Four-Point and Ten-Point Systems of fabric inspection. [U] / [CO3]

➢ 4 - POINT SYSTEM

The 4-Point System is a widely used method for evaluating and grading fabric quality based on the size of defects. It is commonly used in garment and textile industries for both supplier inspection and incoming fabric inspection.
The Main Principle is bigger the defect, the higher the penalty points.
A single defect is assigned a maximum of 4 penalty points based on its size.

Point Allocation

Size of defect	Points
Up to 3 inches	1 point
Over 3 – 6 inches	2 points
Over 6 – 9 inches	3 points
Over 9 inches	4 points

- 10 - POINT SYSTEM

The 10-Point System is a traditional method of evaluating and grading fabric quality based on the size and severity of fabric defects. It is mainly used for inspecting and grading woven fabrics, particularly in textile and garment industries.
The Main Principle is that larger defects are given higher penalty points because they have a greater effect on fabric quality.
A defect is assigned penalty points according to its length/size, with a maximum of 10 points for a single defect.

Point Allocation

Size of defect	Points
Up to 1 inch	1 point
Over 1 – 5 inches	3 points
Over 5 – 10 inches	5 points
Over 10 inches	10 points

19. Describe the importance of thread trimming in finished garments.

Trimming in Finishing Department
Trimming is the process of removing loose threads, excess fabric and unwanted materials from a finished garment to improve its appearance and quality.
Main purpose [U] / [CO5]

- Thread trimming: Removes loose and excess sewing threads.
- Excess fabric removal: Removes unwanted fabric around seams and other garment parts.
- Cleaning: Removes dust, lint and minor stains from the garment.
- Defect checking: Identifies visible defects before the garment is packed.
- Label checking: Ensures labels and tags are correctly attached and positioned.

20. Explain the steps involved in payment through a documentary LC. [U] / [CO5]
[4x5 = 20]

A Letter of Credit (L/C) is a payment method in which the buyer's bank guarantees payment to the exporter when the exporter fulfil the conditions mentioned in the L/C and submits the required documents.
In garment exports, the buyer opens the L/C through their bank, and the exporter manufactures and ships the garments. After shipment, the exporter submits documents such as the commercial invoice, packing list, and Bill of Lading to the bank. The bank checks the documents and makes payment according to the L/C terms.
L/C may be Sight L/C, where payment is made immediately after document verification, or Usance L/C, where payment is made after an agreed period.

Part C

Essays

Answer any 3 questions

Each question carries 10 marks

21. Explain the complete process of fabric sourcing in garment manufacturing.

SOURCING OF FABRICS
Fabric sourcing refers to the process of identifying, evaluating and selecting suitable fabric suppliers according to the requirements of a particular garment order.
The objective of fabric sourcing is to obtain the right fabric in the required quality, quantity, price and delivery period. [U] / [CO2]
The sourcing team looks for fabrics that meet the buyer's requirements for:

- Fabric type – cotton, polyester, denim, linen, viscose, etc.
- Fabric construction – woven or knitted.
- Weight/GSM – how heavy or light the fabric is.
- Colour and shade – matching the buyer's approved colour.

- Composition – e.g., 100% cotton or 60% cotton + 40% polyester. Etc…

TYPES OF SOURCING

Local sourcing → Supplier is within the country.
Global sourcing → Supplier is in another country.
Direct sourcing → Buyer deals directly with the manufacturer.
Indirect sourcing → An intermediary is involved.
Online Sourcing → Sourcing and Check availability of fabric through online.

22. What is a Customer Profile? Explain the major components of a customer profile and describe how it helps a fashion or garment business. [U] / [CO3]

Customer Profile
A customer profile contains information about the buyer.
Its a detailed record of a buyer's preferences, purchasing patterns, quality requirements, and target market.
It helps merchandisers understand the needs and expectations of their customers. For example, a premium fashion brand may prefer organic fabrics, high-quality stitching, and sustainable packaging.
Understanding the customer profile enables merchandisers to provide better service and maintain strong business relationships.

23. Describe the different types of merchandising and explain their major characteristics. [U] / [CO1]

1. Export Merchandising
   - Export merchandising is the process of planning, coordinating, and managing garment export orders for international buyers.
   - It acts as a link between the buyer and the manufacturer.
   - It ensures that buyer requirements are fulfilled accurately and on time.
   - It focuses on delivering the right product, in the right quantity, at the right quality and price.
2. Visual Merchandising
   - Visual merchandising is the art and science of presenting products attractively to customers.
   - It focuses on improving the appearance of products and retail stores.
   - It helps attract customers and influence purchasing decisions.
   - It creates an appealing shopping environment.
3. Digital Merchandising
   - Digital merchandising refers to the presentation and promotion of products through online platforms.
   - It involves managing products on websites, mobile apps, and e-commerce marketplaces.
   - It aims to improve the online shopping experience.
   - It helps businesses reach customers worldwide.
4. Retail Merchandising
   - Retail merchandising involves planning and selling products directly to consumers.
   - It ensures that products are available at the right place and time.
   - It focuses on maximizing sales and customer satisfaction.
5. Cross Merchandising
   - Cross merchandising is the practice of displaying related products together.
   - It encourages customers to purchase complementary items.
   - It helps increase the value of customer purchases.
6. Product Merchandising
   - Product merchandising focuses on developing and managing products according to customer needs.
   - It involves planning products based on market demand and fashion trends.
   - It ensures products remain competitive in the marketplace.
7. Omnichannel Merchandising
   - Omnichannel merchandising integrates multiple sales channels into a single shopping experience.
   - It combines physical stores, websites, mobile apps, and social media platforms.
   - It provides customers with a seamless shopping journey.

24. Explain position marking (drill marking) and bundle ticketing used in the preparation for sewing. [U] / [CO4]

For the materials are prepare before sewing its gone through different stages include – Merker making, Spreading, Pattern Laying, Cutting, Bundling and Ticketing, Position Marking, Drill Marking, etc…

- BUNDLING & TICKETING

Bundling is the process of grouping cut garment components according to style, size, colour, shade and production sequence.
One shirt bundle may contain:

- Front, Back, Sleeve, Collar, Cuff, Pocket, Placket etc…

Importance

- Prevents component mixing.
- Maintains production sequence.
- Facilitates line feeding.
- Reduces missing components.

Ticketing means attaching identification tickets to garment bundles/components to provide production information and maintain traceability.
Information may include

- Style number
- Size
- Bundle number
- Lot number

1. Position Marking: Position marking is the process of marking the exact location of garment components or construction details on cut fabric pieces before sewing. It helps the sewing operator correctly place features such as pockets, buttons, darts, pleats, collars and labels.	2. Drill Marking: Drill marking is the process of making small holes or marks at specific positions on fabric pieces using a drill or marking tool. These marks serve as accurate reference points for sewing and assembling garment components, such as pocket placement, darts, button positions and other details.

25. Compare sea shipment and air shipment with respect to cost, speed, capacity, suitability and reliability. [U] / [CO5]

- Sea Transportation

Transportation of goods through ships and cargo vessels across seas and oceans.
Advantages

- Suitable for large quantities
- Lower cost per unit for international bulk shipments
- Suitable for containerized garment exports
- Ideal for long-distance international transportation

Disadvantages

- Slow compared with air transportation
- Dependent on port schedules

- Air Transportation

Transportation of goods using cargo aircraft or commercial aircraft cargo services.
Advantages

- Very fast
- Suitable for urgent shipments
- Long international distances can be covered quickly

Disadvantages

- Very expensive
- Limited cargo capacity compared with ships

[10x3 = 30]

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